Livecast

How to set up a broadcast, simply.

The flow, simplified:



The software is free (MIT) and rebrandable: name, colours and images are changed from the panel, no code edits needed.

Quick guide · version 1.0 · https://github.com/sdagostino777/livecast

1. What you need

1. **OBS Studio** on a computer (Windows, macOS, Linux) — the program that sends the video. Free, `obsproject.com`.
2. **A VPS** running Ubuntu (4 GB of RAM is plenty for one broadcast) and a **domain** with a DNS `A` record pointing at the VPS.
3. The Livecast repository, and five minutes for the initial install.

1. Download it (once)

On GitHub: green **Code → Download ZIP** (fine from a phone too — upload the ZIP to the server). From a terminal:

```
curl -L https://github.com/sdagostino777/livecast/archive/refs/heads/main.tar.gz -o livecast.tgz
```

```
tar xzf livecast.tgz && cd livecast-main
```

2. One command installs everything

In your server's terminal (Hostinger → VPS → **Terminal**, as root), inside the folder you just unpacked, type:

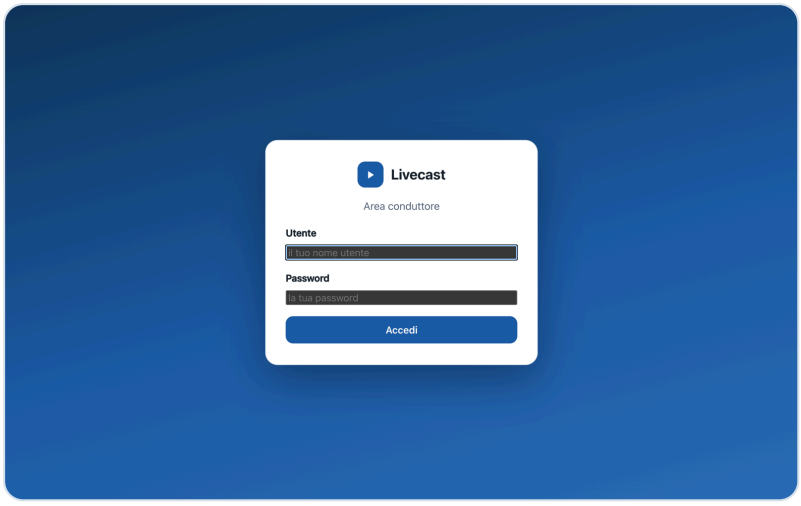
```
bash install.sh live.yourdomain.com
```

It installs the media server, the encoder, the services that restart themselves after a failure, free HTTPS, the firewall and the **admin** account. Nothing else: OBS is not mandatory and no file needs editing by hand.

3. First login: open `https://live.yourdomain.com/admin`, user **admin**, password **admin**. The panel **forces you to change it immediately**: pick at least 12 characters and you are in.

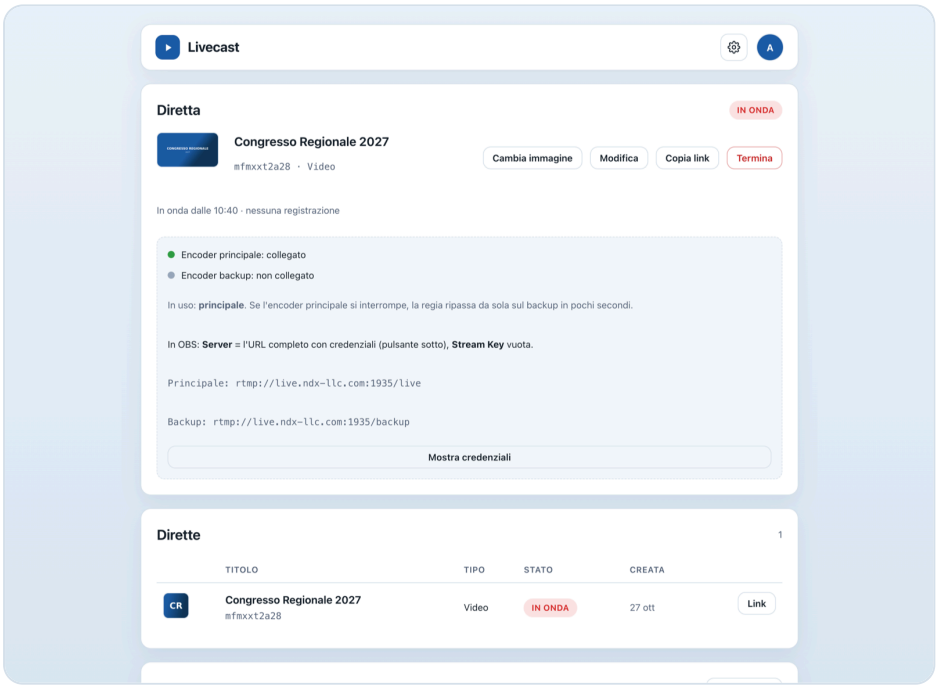
2. First login and creating a broadcast

Open the panel link and sign in. Top right you will find the gear (settings) and your avatar with **Esci** (sign out).



1. Sign-in screen.

In the **Diretta** box write the title — for example **Congresso Regionale** or **Evento semestrale** — choose **Video** or **Audio only**, add the **event image** and **icon** if you want, then press **Crea** (create). The broadcast appears under **Dirette** with a **Vai in onda** (go live) button: press it when you are ready.

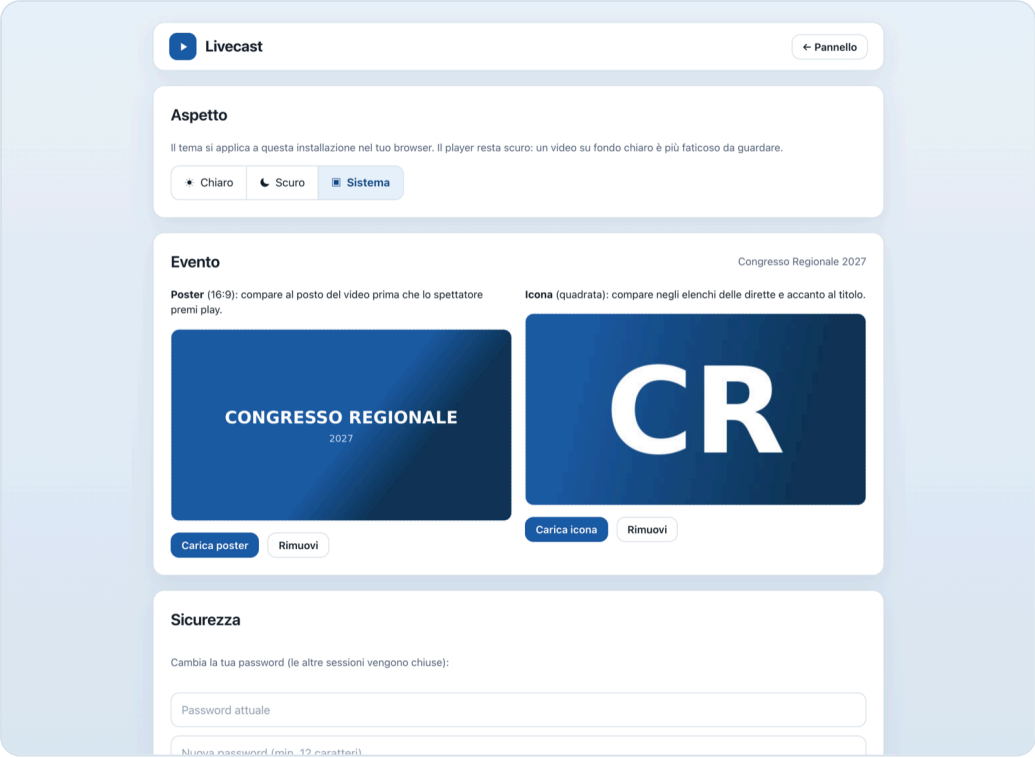


2. The panel: create the broadcast, with connection LEDs.

No image at hand? The system **generates one** from the event title on a gradient background (deep navy, petrol, indigo…). Replace it whenever you like with “Carica immagine”.

3. Settings (the gear)

The gear (top right) opens the settings page: **Appearance** (light, dark or system theme), **Event** (the image viewers see before pressing play, and the square icon), **Security** (your password) and **Users** (admin only).



2b. Settings: theme, event image, security, users.

4. Going live

Two ways, no mandatory software. In the panel, under the broadcast, you find **Pubblica da camera** and **Condividi schermo**: the browser transmits directly. The page must stay open during the broadcast — reloading it stops the transmission. For long events OBS is the safer choice (it reconnects by itself): here is how to configure it.

In the panel press **Mostra credenziali** (show credentials) and copy the full server URL. In OBS → **Settings → Stream**:

OBS Studio — Settings → Stream

Service	Custom…
Server	rtmp://live.yourdomain.com:1935/live?user=publisher&pass=••••••
Stream key	*(empty)*

Press **Start streaming** in OBS: the panel turns to **In onda** within seconds. Copy the broadcast link and share it. Viewers see the poster and a play button — play and pause, nothing more.



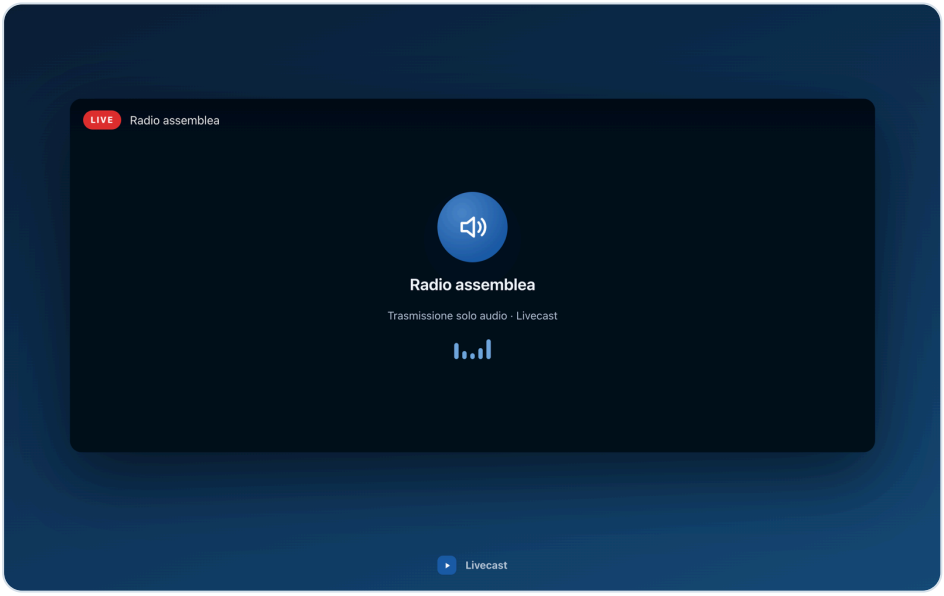
4. Before play: the event poster and the play button.

4. What the viewer sees

During the broadcast: play and pause, the **LIVE** badge and the title. Nothing else — every extra control is one more thing to get wrong on a phone in a crowd.



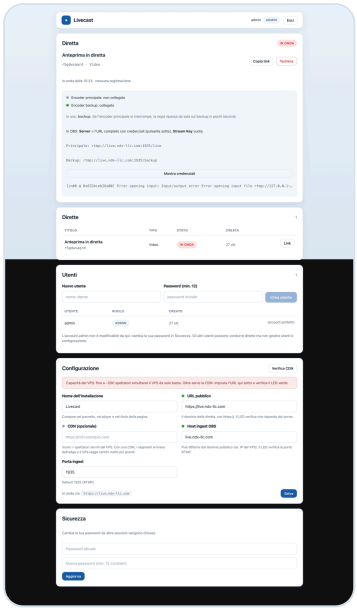
5. The player: play and pause only, as it should be.



6. An «Audio only» broadcast: same simplicity, with the audio card.

5. Viewers, CDN and the unexpected

How many viewers does the VPS handle? Up to **~500 simultaneous** the VPS alone is enough. Beyond that you need a CDN: in the panel → **Configurazione** enter the CDN URL and check that the LED next to it 🟢 turns **green**. With a CDN viewers load video from the edge and the VPS stays light.



5. Green LEDs = active connections. “In uso: backup” = the second encoder took over.

When things break

1. **OBS disconnects** → the encoder restarts by itself within seconds; when OBS reconnects the video returns.
2. **The primary encoder dies** → if a second encoder is connected to the backup URL, the panel shows “In uso: backup” and the broadcast continues.
3. **The server dies** → no software on that server can save it: you need a standby VPS with the data (the `DATA_DIR` folder) and DNS re-pointed. That is the emergency plan to prepare for important events.

Where to find the rest

README · **docs/RUNBOOK.md** (operations, CDN, recovery) · **docs/CDN.md** (Bunny CDN step by step) · **docs/guides/guide-it.pdf** (this guide in Italian).